

All The Fullness

Chad Haygood · Grace Life Church, Hastings, NE · October 4, 2026

Colossians

1:15-20

PRIMARY TEXT

35 min

SERMON LENGTH

23

SCRIPTURE
REFERENCES

19

SECTIONS WE MAPPED

THE SERMON IN ONE SENTENCE

Because all the fullness of God dwells in Christ and He alone reconciles us to God through His blood, nothing can be added to Him—He is completely sufficient.

Summary

Chad Haygood preaches on Colossians 1:15-20, addressing the Jesus-plus mentality that threatened the Colossian church—the idea that Christ is good but insufficient, needing supplements of special knowledge, visions, or religious experiences. Before dismantling these alternatives in chapter 2, Paul magnifies Christ in chapter 1: He is the image of the invisible God, Creator and sustainer of all things, head of the church, firstborn from the dead, and the dwelling place of all God's fullness. The sermon's controlling thesis is that an enormous view of Christ is the best defense against every Jesus-plus alternative. If all the fullness of deity dwells in Christ, nothing is missing and nothing can be added. The sermon moves from cosmic Christology—Christ created all things, holds all things together, and will reconcile all things—to the pastoral and sacramental application: peace with God is not something we make but something Christ made by His blood, and we receive it at the table with empty hands.

YOUR SERMON PAGE

<https://sermonsteward.com/SGchurch/GraceLifeHastings/sermons/all-the-fullness-2026-10-04>

THIS WEEK ACROSS THE REGION

<https://sermonsteward.com/SGchurch/MidwestNorthwest/10-4-26/>

Eight Sovereign Grace churches, one Sunday: Scripture, themes, and How We Said It.

What We Noticed

Doctrinal loci

- **Christology** — The sermon's entire structure is a sustained exposition of Christ's person and work—His deity, eternality, creative agency, sustaining power, headship over the church, resurrection, reconciling death, and cosmic preeminence.
- **Theology Proper** — The sermon establishes that Christ is the image of the invisible God and that all the fullness of deity dwells in Him bodily, making knowledge of God possible only through Christ and rendering all alternatives idolatrous.
- **Soteriology** — The sermon emphasizes that peace with God is not something we contribute to or make up deficiencies in, but something Christ accomplished objectively by the blood of His cross and we receive by faith with empty hands.
- **Providence / Sovereignty** — The sermon exposit Christ's sustaining work—all things hold together in Him—and applies it with the dramatic illustration that even at the cross, Christ was sustaining the wood, nails, and breath of His executioners.

Themes

The sufficiency of Christ

Christ as Creator and sustainer

The Jesus-plus mentality

Peace through the blood of the cross

Christ's preeminence over all things

Reconciliation of all creation

Editor notes

- The sermon's rhetorical strategy is architectonic: before applying anything, Haygood builds an enormous Christology, trusting that the best defense against Jesus-plus teaching is a maximalist vision of Christ rather than point-by-point refutation.
- The cross illustration in unit 10—Christ sustaining the wood and nails and breath of those killing Him—is the sermon's most powerful theological-rhetorical moment, collapsing cosmic doctrine into cruciform paradox.
- The Spurgeon quotation ('we are not asked to contribute nor required to make up deficiencies, for there are none to make up') functions as the sermon's hinge between Christology and application, distilling the whole argument into a single declarative sentence.
- The sermon's sacramental conclusion is liturgically concrete (come hungry, come believing, come with empty hands) while maintaining the theological abstraction that has characterized the entire sermon—no specific behavioral instructions are given.

Writing Prompts

Concepts from each main point you could explore further in your own reading and writing.

1. Why an Enormous View of Christ Is the Best Defense Against Jesus-Plus Teaching

Instead of refuting false teaching point by point, Paul magnifies Christ. The article argues that the best apologetic strategy against every Jesus-plus alternative is not argument but adoration—showing people who Christ is until the alternatives collapse under their own insufficiency.

FROM: UNIT 3, THE SERMON'S CONTROLLING THESIS

2. Christ Is Not Like God—He Is the Image of the Invisible God

The article unpacks the doctrine of revelation: God is invisible and can only be known if He reveals Himself. Christ is not merely similar to God or a pointer to God—He is the exact imprint of God's nature. Anything offering knowledge of God apart from Christ is idolatry.

FROM: UNIT 4, EXPOSITION OF 'IMAGE OF THE INVISIBLE GOD'

3. Firstborn Over Creation: How the Bible Uses Rank Language, Not Birth Order

The article traces the biblical-theological meaning of 'firstborn' as a term of inheritance and rank rather than chronological sequence, using Psalm 89's application of firstborn language to David (Jesse's youngest son) to show that Christ is firstborn over creation as its heir and Lord, not as the first creature made.

FROM: UNIT 5, EXPOSITION OF 'FIRSTBORN OF ALL CREATION'

4. All Things Were Created Through Him and For Him

The article explores the shift from 'through Him' to 'for Him' in Colossians 1:16, moving from cosmic scope (thrones, dominions, rulers, authorities) to local application (the moon, Nebraska cornfields, marriage, work, bodies, children). Everything exists not just by Christ but for Christ.

FROM: UNIT 7, EXPOSITION OF CREATION'S SCOPE AND TELOS

5. Why Christianity Cannot Be Confined to One Corner of Life

Because Christ made everything and everything is for Him, Christianity is not compartmentalizable. The article applies the doctrine of Christ's sovereignty over all things to the totality of Christian life—our Mondays belong to Christ just as much as our Sundays.

FROM: UNIT 8, APPLICATION OF CHRIST'S COSMIC LORDSHIP

6. The Cross Where Creation Killed Its Creator While the Creator Sustained the Creation

The article builds a theological vision of the crucifixion moment from Colossians 1:17: if Christ holds all things together, then even as He was being crucified, He was sustaining the wood, the nails, and the breath of His mockers. The paradox reveals the depth of Christ's condescension and the extent of His sustaining power.

FROM: UNIT 10, THE CROSS ILLUSTRATION

7. All the Fullness of God Dwells in Christ—Nothing Is Missing, Nothing Can Be Added

The article expositis Colossians 1:19 to dismantle the Jesus-plus mentality: if all the fullness of deity dwells in Christ bodily, then nothing is missing and nothing can be added. The article distinguishes growth from addition—we grow up into the gospel, not beyond it.

FROM: UNIT 12, EXPOSITION OF FULLNESS AND SUFFICIENCY

8. Peace with God Is Not Something We Make—It Is Something Christ Made by His Blood

The article diagnoses the human condition (we are enemies, not confused), establishes the necessity of reconciliation, and emphasizes the objectivity of Christ's atoning work. Peace is not something we contribute to or manufacture—it is something Christ accomplished and we receive by faith with empty hands.

FROM: UNIT 14, EXPOSITION OF RECONCILIATION AND PEACE

9. Christ Reconciled All Things: From Your Salvation to the Cosmic Restoration

The article extends the scope of reconciliation from personal salvation to cosmic restoration, sketching the eschatological consummation when every corner of creation will be delivered from corruption and every enemy will be put beneath Christ's feet. The reconciliation is as comprehensive as the creation.

FROM: UNIT 15, EXPOSITION OF COSMIC RECONCILIATION

Congregation Resources

The same resources published on your sermon page.

Small-Group Discussion

In Colossians 1:15, Paul describes Jesus as 'the image of the invisible God.' What does it mean that Jesus is the image of God, and how does this claim address the Colossians' pressure to seek hidden knowledge or deeper spiritual experiences elsewhere?

↳ How does understanding Jesus as God's image change the way you think about knowing God—is there any knowledge of God available to us that isn't revealed in Jesus?

JOHN 14:9; HEBREWS 1:3

According to Colossians 1:16-17, what is Christ's relationship to creation, and what does it mean practically that 'all things hold together in him'?

↳ If all things—including your work, your relationships, your Monday morning—hold together in Christ, what changes about how you approach those things this week?

COLOSSIANS 1:16-17

The sermon identifies a 'Jesus-plus' temptation in the Colossian church—the impulse to add special knowledge, rules, or experiences to their faith in Christ. What forms does this same temptation take in our own lives and churches today?

↳ What makes these additions feel necessary or compelling to us, even when we know Christ is sufficient?

Colossians 1:19-20 states that 'all the fullness of God was pleased to dwell in him, and through him to reconcile to himself all things, whether on earth or in heaven, making peace by the blood of his cross.' How does Christ's fullness and His reconciling work through His blood address our deepest need—the broken relationship between ourselves and God?

↳ When you come to worship or to the Lord's Table, do you come believing you have something to contribute to your peace with God, or do you come with empty hands to receive what Christ has already made?

COLOSSIANS 1:14; COLOSSIANS 1:21; ROMANS 5:1

The sermon teaches that because Christ made everything and sustains everything, 'Christianity cannot be confined to one corner of life—our Mondays belong to Christ just as much as our Sundays.' What would it look like to live Monday through Friday as if Christ is truly Lord of all things, not just of religious activities?

↳ Where do you find yourself compartmentalizing your faith—treating some areas of life as belonging fully to Christ and others as more negotiable?

If all the fullness of God dwells in Christ and nothing can be added to Him, what does it mean for our lives that He chooses to give Himself to us? How does His sufficiency and His self-giving reshape the way we approach our relationship with Him?

↳ How might grasping that Christ needs nothing from us actually free us to serve Him and others more joyfully?

COLOSSIANS 2:9

Daily Readings

This week we walk through five portraits of Christ's sufficiency—His divine nature, His creative power, His headship, His resurrection triumph, and His reconciling work—each one answering the lie that anything can be added to Him.

Monday Hebrews 1:3

Hebrews clarifies what Colossians declares: Christ is not a pale reflection of God's character but the radiance of His glory—the very light of divinity made visible. When we see Jesus, we see God Himself. This is the foundation of everything else Paul will say about Christ's sufficiency; if all of God's glory and being rests in Him, there is literally nothing else to seek.

Tuesday Colossians 2:9

Paul repeats this staggering claim with intensity: the complete, undiminished fullness of God—not a portion, not an echo—inhabits Christ in bodily form. This is not a theological abstraction but a concrete historical reality. The Colossians were being tempted to supplement Christ with secret knowledge and spiritual experiences, but Paul shows them that they already possess everything; Christ contains it all.

Wednesday 1 Corinthians 15:20

Christ's resurrection is not one miracle among many—it is the hinge on which creation's redemption turns. As the firstfruits, He guarantees the harvest; His rising from death declares that He alone holds power over the grave and that all things will be restored through Him. This is why nothing can be added to Him; He has conquered what we cannot and made a way none of us could make.

Thursday Romans 5:1

Paul's logic is relentless: our reconciliation is not something we construct through works, deeper experiences, or hidden knowledge—it is something Christ purchased with His own blood and offers to us with empty hands. We come as receivers, not achievers. The peace we desperately seek is already complete in His finished work; we need only receive it in faith.

Friday Colossians 2:6-7

If Christ is enough—the foundation of all things, the head of the church, the source of peace and redemption—then our entire lives belong to Him. We cannot compartmentalize Jesus to the spiritual realm while keeping our work, relationships, and daily decisions separate. The natural response to such fullness is to let Him reign over all we are and do, together walking in the reality that everything we touch is His.

Memory Verse

For in him all the fullness of God was pleased to dwell.
— **Colossians 1:19**

This verse crystallizes the sermon's central claim that nothing can be added to Christ because all the fullness of God dwells in Him alone. It is the theological foundation upon which the entire defense against the Jesus-plus mentality rests.

Family Conversation

What Can We Add to Jesus?

Pastor Chad said that some people in the church at Colossae thought they needed to add special rules or secret knowledge to Jesus to really know God. If Jesus is God Himself—if all of God lives in Him—why would we ever need to add anything to Him? What might we try to add to Jesus today, and why do you think we do that?

WORKS FOR AGES 8+

For parents: This card invites kids to think about why people try to add things to Jesus—extra rules, special knowledge, or practices they think will make them "more Christian." Listen for whether they grasp that Jesus is already completely full and complete; the goal is to help them see that following Jesus doesn't require anything extra.

For Couples

Christ is Enough

What part of Christ's fullness—His power as Creator, His headship over the church, His reconciliation through His blood—most humbled or amazed you as you heard it preached?

Where are we tempted, together or individually, to add something to Christ—a spiritual practice, a standard, a relationship, a pursuit—as if He were not fully sufficient for our peace and wholeness?

How can we pray for one another this week to rest more deeply in the finished work of Christ and to release whatever we've been trying to add to Him?

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